

Build Ace Express's first AI writer

PREPARED FOR TONY MCGUINNESS AND EAMON GALAVAN, ACE EXPRESS FREIGHT · PRIVATE

01

What this is

Good chatting to you both on Tuesday. Below is a list of the things I build. You would likely get use out of a lot of them in time, but you said you wanted to start narrow and see something working first. So I am recommending one thing to begin with, the LinkedIn writer, and it is in section eight.

02

What we do

Quality first, then automate

Before I build anything, I ask one question: what does really good look like here? Not what AI can do, but what the best version of this marketing would be, and the level of quality and effectiveness I would want to stand over.

So I start where I always have. If there were no AI at all, what team would I hire to do this properly? I map that team first, the one I would build in a world before any of this existed.

Then I build exactly that, with agents instead of hires. The quality bar is set by the team I would have wanted, not by whatever a tool happens to make easy. Twenty years in brand is what tells me where that bar sits: Head of Brand at O2 Ireland, then CMO at the National Lottery, Head of Brand at Indeed and Miro, both global roles. Positioning, messaging and tone written first, then built into everything the agents make.

Ireland's Marketer of the Year, 2022 · Who I work with: Moloco, Heineken, Norcros, Alltech, Smurfit, Hostelworld, Eaton Square, Weatherbys

"His command of marketing science as well as his instincts for great thinking and ideas are, in my opinion, superb."

Peter Field, The Godfather of Effectiveness, author of The Long and the Short of It

"Paul reported into me as Head of Brand when I was at Indeed. I have learned more from him than anyone else in my career."

Paul D'Arcy, CMO, Moloco. Former CMO at Miro and Indeed

03

What Run with Foxes does

I firmly believe that marketing structures, marketing teams and marketing roles are going to change dramatically in the next few years, and the work we do is all around that. Specifically, there are four buckets to what we currently do. We train teams. We build AI agents and capabilities for them, or with them. We work with marketing leaders to re-imagine what future workflows could look like, and we design AI adoption programmes for them.

Rethinking the roles

Individual productivity gets you started. Make everyone on a team a little faster and the work still queues in the same places, because the bottleneck just moves down the line. The process, the people and the policies have to change together, and that starts with what each role actually is.

We start by laying out the work to be done, not the team chart. Then we redesign how that work gets done and remove the handovers.

Training teams

Firstly, there is a free course, AI Fluency for Ambitious Marketers, for anybody on your team. We also run training sessions for marketing, sales and go-to-market teams. These range from half a day to full-week sessions. We cover a range of topics, from pure productivity hacks to building agents and systems. System thinking is a core skill for marketing in an AI world.

the course, module one free, live now

/Runwithfoxes course

MODULE 1 OF 6 · OPENS MON 21 SEP

The 80/20 of AI

Hello and thank you for signing up to this. Later in this course we get into big things. Building agents, thinking in systems and doing stuff that wasn't possible six months ago.

But this module is not that. This is a bunch of things that I do, often without even thinking about it. If you already do these too, skip them. I'm not going to show you how to use AI, although will send you links to guides. There's loads available. My focus is marketing, and I care about both quality and speed, so that is the lens for this course.

You'll see Isa, my assistant chatbot on your left. It can answer questions if you have any. You know how to find me too.

One request. You'll see an AI fluency question below. I'd love if you can answer it now. And there's another one at the end of Module 6. That way, I can assess how useful this course is, and find ways to improve it.

Opens Mon 21 Sep In this module 10 things Source Paul's own article, 21 May 2026 Sharing Copy anything. Send it on.

/the course, module one. Free and live now at runwithfoxes.com/course.

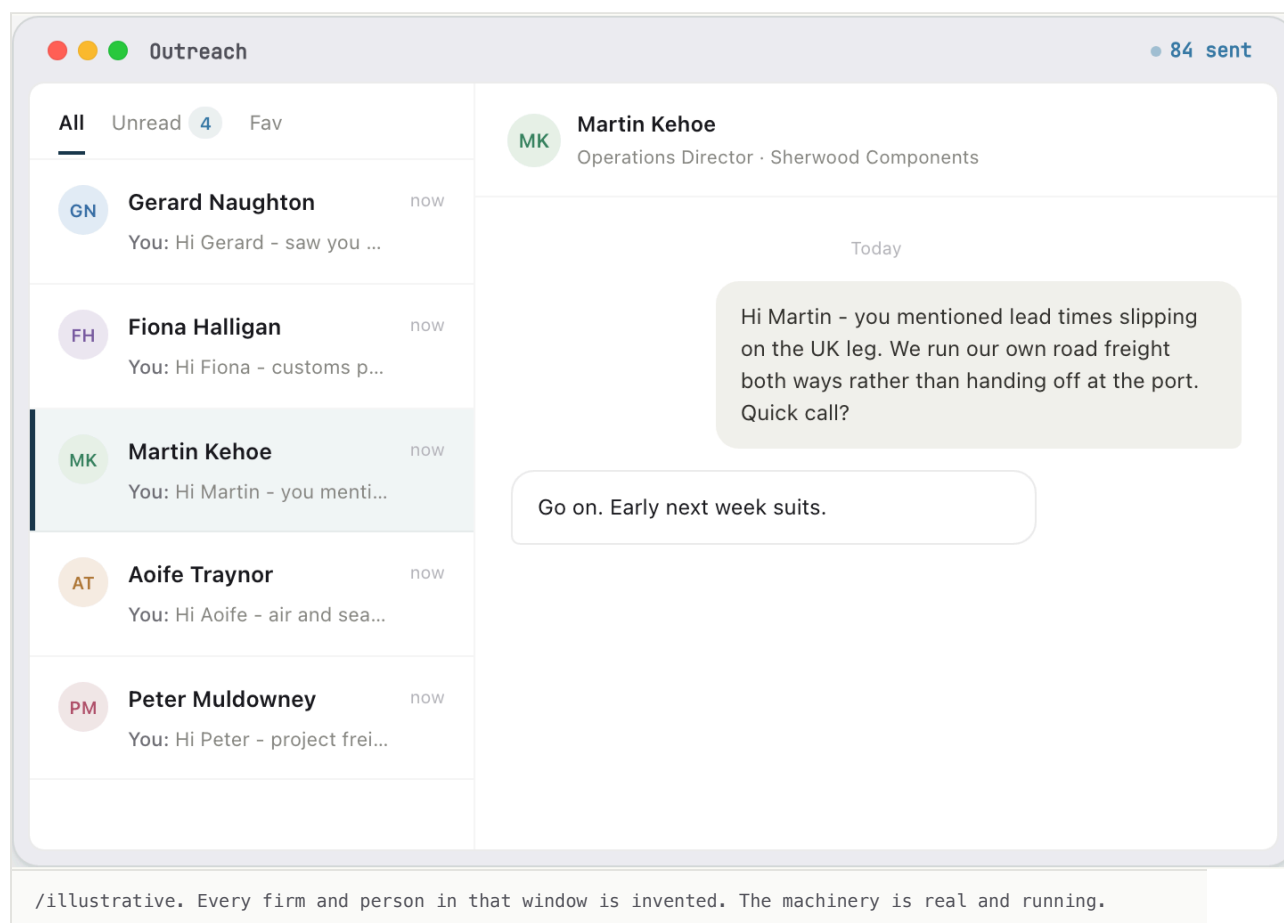
Redesigning workflows

Redesigning workflows is the harder work, and it is what my new book is about. It is harder not because of the tech or the tools, but because it is about people: their roles, their responsibilities, and sometimes their identities. We map out the activities and how they flow, from a brief through to campaigns and analysis, including the handovers, the time each step takes, the documents and artefacts created, the tools used, and the sign-offs. Then we re-imagine what is possible, both now and in the very near future, starting from a blank page. This is my core skill, as it is what I did building teams client-side for most of my career.

Building agents

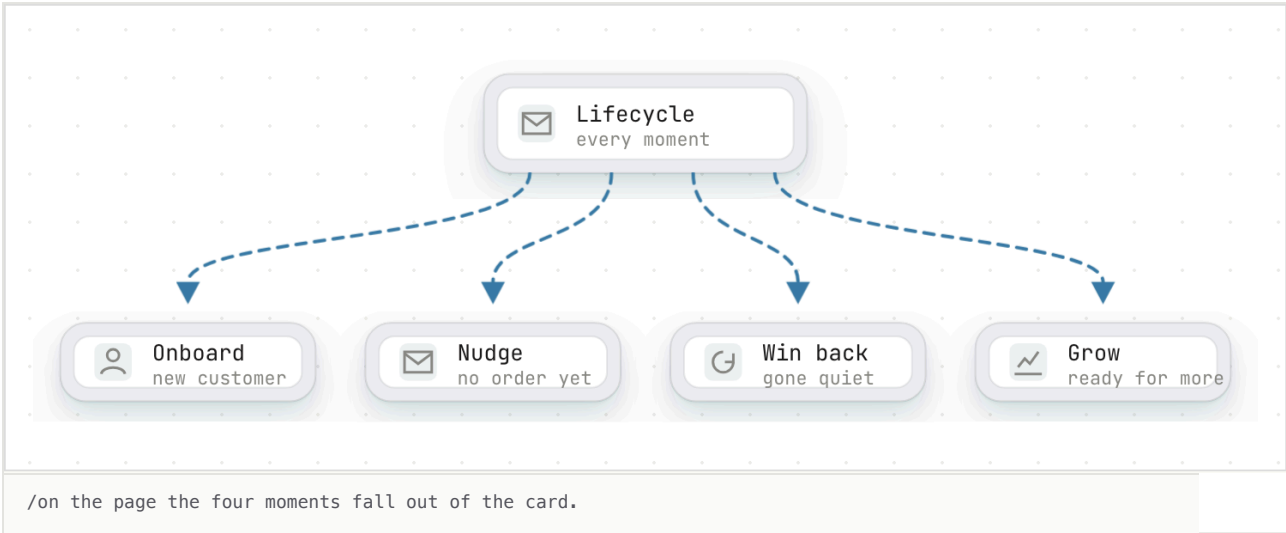
Outbound Agent

The Outbound Agent finds the right companies and the right people inside them, researches each one, writes a message that is genuinely about that company rather than a template with a name dropped into it, sends it, and reports back on what is working. It runs the whole sequence, on email or LinkedIn or both, and nothing goes out until someone on your team says go.



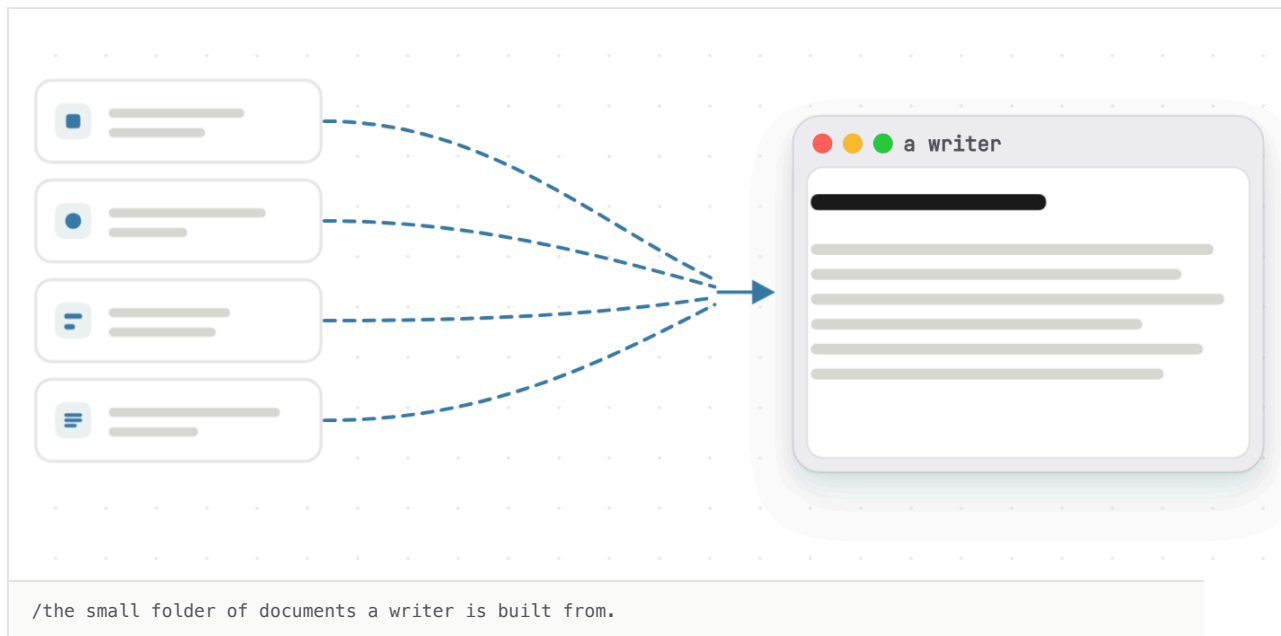
Lifecycle Agent

Lifecycle email is the work of keeping and growing the people who already know you. Onboarding a new customer, nudging someone who has not ordered yet, winning back one who has gone quiet, growing the ones ready for more. It is where a lot of revenue comes from, and it usually gets skipped because it never stops. The Lifecycle Agent runs it.



AI Writers

I read a lot about how AI writes slop. It does. But it doesn't have to. If you spend time up front. Writers need to know your brand's positioning, your target audience, insights or pain points related to your category. They need to know your brand's messaging, and your tone of voice. On top of that, we need to articulate instructions on how we want the writer to interact with us or our colleagues.



08

My recommendation: The AI writer

We would build one agent that writes LinkedIn posts for Tony, Eamon and Philip. It researches topics, comes up with the ideas, and writes the posts. You read what it has written, choose the ones you want to use, and paste them into LinkedIn from your own profiles.

How you would use it

Once a month you would get a month's worth of posts in one go. You pick the ones you like and post them.

The first two weeks

There are two sessions with you, then two weeks of building. The agent has to sound like you, so the sessions are where we get that from you. We would ask what you sell, who buys it, why customers pick you over another forwarder, and what a good post sounds like coming from a director. We write that up as your positioning and messaging.

The two weeks are the build and the testing. We build the agent on top of that positioning and messaging, then run real topics through it and review the output with you. You sign off the writing before anything is published.

Nobody needs a Claude licence

The agent runs on Claude Managed Agents, which is Anthropic's own hosted service. You reach it through our page, so there is no software to install and no per-person licence to buy. Anthropic does not use data sent through its commercial API to train its models, and that is a contractual commitment rather than a setting we switch on. Anthropic holds SOC 2 Type I and Type II, ISO 27001:2022 and ISO 42001:2023, and each session runs in an isolated container.

If you would rather run it in your own Claude account, we can move the whole thing across and show you how to run and extend it yourselves.

What we would build after it

The positioning and messaging we write in those two weeks is what every other agent would run on. If you later wanted email to your existing customers, or prospect research for the sales team, that groundwork would already be done and the next build starts from it rather than from a blank page.

What we'd recommend

We would start with the writer. It is the smallest piece of work that gives you something useful, and it is what you asked for on the call. You would see posts going out from your own profiles within about a month of it going live.

Three months is long enough for you to judge whether it is worth continuing. At that point you either carry on with us running it, or you take it in-house and run it yourselves. We will hand it over whenever you want it.

The price

THE AI WRITER

LinkedIn posts, written for you

- One agent, calibrated to your positioning, messaging and tone of voice
- Two sessions with you, to get what is in your heads
- Research, ideas and finished posts for three profiles
- A month of posts at a time, for you to read and choose from

EUR 3,500 plus VAT

Then EUR 99 a month, reviewed together after three months.

First three months, to the review

EUR 3,797 plus VAT

WHAT THE PRICE COVERS

All build and calibration work

The two sessions with you

Running the agent for three months

A named point of contact, Paul

WHAT IT DOESN'T

Any tool subscriptions on your side

LinkedIn advertising or any media spend

If you would rather run it yourselves at any point, we will hand it over. You would run it in your own Claude account and the monthly stops.

If this looks right, the next step is a conversation, not a contract.
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Case studies

Starting with the big companies, and with the one I did from the inside, running the teams rather than advising them.

Miro

150 marketers · brand strategy, advertising, marketing communications, the studio

We were spending about \$1.2 million on design and studio work. When I realised what was possible I set a target to reduce it by 20%, and that 20% was the low hanging fruit, the low skill design work.

It took a combination of things. AI to make the images, the video and the copy. A training structure and a training programme. Extra Canva licences. And changes to the brand guidelines and the policies, so that people who were not marketers could serve themselves and move with speed, while keeping everything consistent across the work.

\$1.2m spent on design and studio work → **\$240k** taken out, inside a year

Moloco

50 to 60 marketers

They wanted to hire a copywriter. I persuaded them to let me build copywriters in AI instead, and they use them all the time.

The part that matters is what goes into one. A copywriter is built with the positioning, the messaging framework, the pain points and the proof points. That is what makes what comes out usable rather than generic.

I am also building them a brand guardian, and an AI identity generator, which takes all the elements of their brand identity and reproduces them at speed.

Sabre

AI adoption programme, marketing first

I have been building capabilities for Sabre, and I now work alongside their champion inside the marketing team, their marketing director. A combination of him on the inside and me on the outside.

Together we have designed an AI adoption programme for marketing, which we are rolling out now and will extend into go to market.

Alongside the programme I have built them writers, brand guardians, a search agent, a brief coach to improve the quality of their briefs, and an advertising creative role.

Run with Foxes · Private, prepared for Ace Express Freight. The live version of this document, with every exhibit running, is the page this was printed from.